On your first day inside, you meet a friendly inmate who is willing to guide you as to the everyday of the prison, such as the meal and tea timings, securing a place to sleep, cleanliness, what the best time to use the bathroom is, etc. They also tell you about organisations which help under-trial prisoners secure bail.

KHEL RIHAAI KA

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PRE-BAIL

You are able to secure a job of your choice in the prison. It is work that you enjoy, and you quickly get the hang of it. You develop a rapport with your co-workers, and are able to forget the severity of the circumstance while working and joking around with them.

KHEL RIHAAI KA

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PRE-BAIL

The lawyer assigned to your case is extremely considerate. They clearly and patiently explain the charges levelled against you, alongside what their strategy is to help you secure bail. Your family is also reassured as a result of this.

KHEL RIHAAI KA

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PRE-BAIL

On the day of the *mulaqat*, everything goes without a hitch. You wake up early and get dressed because you want to look presentable for the occasion. You are delighted to see your parents and are able to have a proper conversation with them despite the chaos. They reassure you as to the financial situation of the family. They are optimistic about the case. When you return to the barracks, it is with a spring in your step.

KHEL RIHAAI KA

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PRE-BAIL

On the day of your hearing, your lawyer reassures you about their continued support and guidance even if the case appears to be proceeding slowly and/or not in the most favourable direction. Everything manages to begin on time, and the judge attentively listens to the arguments. By the end, the judge announces that bail will be granted on the date of the next hearing.

KHEL RIHAAI KA

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PRE-BAIL

When the date of the next hearing arrives, the bail is granted at once. Your family rejoices and your lawyer congratulates you for the same. When you step into the jail again, you know it is for the last time. Your friends ask you to treat them for the good news by buying them some chocolates and cookies from the canteen. They ask you to recount the proceedings of the hearing, and you are all too happy to do a dramatic re-enactment.

BAIL

BAIL

KHEL RIHAAI KA

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POST-BAIL

Your lawyer has informed you that once the Bail Order arrives, a series of steps need to be followed to acquire the Release Order, which is what will finally allow you to return home. When the bail order arrives, the jail staff informs you of the same.

KHEL RIHAAI KA

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POST-BAIL

You carefully check the information within the Bail Order. Other inmates have made you aware of the fact that any error within the Bail Order will mean that your release will be pushed back by over a week. Luckily, nothing seems to be amiss. All the dhaaras are mentioned, alongside your correctly-spelt name address. You let out a sigh of relief. Getting out is becoming a surer reality. There is only one problem that might arise now.

KHEL RIHAAI KA

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POST-BAIL

Upon checking the surety you are relieved to find that it is an amount you can afford. You phone home to inform your family members of the same. The surety will need to be deposited to the court and processed for the Release Order to arrive.

KHEL RIHAAI KA

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POST-BAIL

Your mother calls you to let you know that they have paid the surety. Now that the surety has been paid, you wait keenly on the Release Order. It is now a matter of two or three days. Every day feels unbearably long.

KHEL RIHAAI KA

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POST-BAIL


RIHAAI


RIHAAI